

Nonprofit CRM Database Schema & Field Configuration Guide

This document outlines a comprehensive CRM database schema designed specifically for a nonprofit organization managing Volunteers, Board Members, and general Members. It serves as a technical blueprint for CRM implementation, detailing the data dictionary and field configurations across four core modules.

MODULE 1: CORE CONSTITUENT PROFILE (Applies to all individuals)

This module establishes the foundational data structure for every individual interacting with the organization, ensuring unified contact management.

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
First Name	Text	Functionality: Captures the constituent's given name. Validation: Required field. Maximum 50 characters. Must not contain numbers.
Last Name	Text	Functionality: Captures the constituent's family name/surname. Validation: Required field. Maximum 80 characters. Used in standard duplicate matching rules.
Primary Email	Email	Functionality: Main email address for communication. Validation: Must follow standard email format (e.g., name@domain.com). Checked against existing records to prevent duplicates.
Primary Phone	Phone	Functionality: Main contact number. Validation: Must be formatted as a valid phone number based on localization (e.g., (XXX) XXX-XXXX for US).
Mailing Address	Address (Compound Field)	Functionality: Stores physical address components (Street, City, State/Province, Zip/Postal Code, Country). Validation: Zip/Postal Code must match the selected Country format.
Account/Household ID	Lookup Relationship	Functionality: Links the individual to a Household or Organization Account to aggregate family or corporate giving/activity. Validation: Must link to an existing Account record.
Employer Name	Text	Functionality: Name of the company where the constituent is employed. Validation: Optional. Can be converted to a Lookup to an Organization Account if B2B tracking is required.

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
Job Title	Text	Functionality: Professional title at the listed employer. Validation: Maximum 100 characters.
Contact Type	Multi-select Picklist	Functionality: Categorizes the constituent's relationship(s) with the nonprofit. Validation: Values: Volunteer , Board , Member , Donor . A constituent can hold multiple types simultaneously.
Contact Notes	Rich Text	Functionality: Free-form area for staff to log qualitative interactions or context. Validation: No strict character limit; supports formatting (bold, links, lists).
Creation Date	Date/Time (System)	Functionality: Automatically stamps the exact date and time the record was created. Validation: Read-only system field. Cannot be manually edited.
Opt-In Email	Checkbox	Functionality: Indicates consent to receive mass email communications. Validation: Default is unchecked (or checked based on regional privacy laws like GDPR/CCPA). Triggers inclusion/exclusion in marketing lists.
Opt-In SMS	Checkbox	Functionality: Indicates consent to receive text messages. Validation: Default is unchecked. Required to be True before automated SMS workflows can execute.
Opt-In Physical Mail	Checkbox	Functionality: Indicates consent to receive direct mail (e.g., newsletters, appeals). Validation: Default is checked (opt-out model typically used for direct mail).

MODULE 2: VOLUNTEER MANAGEMENT

This module tracks volunteer skills, availability, compliance, and impact, linking directly to the Core Constituent Profile.

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
Skills & Interests	Multi-select Picklist	Functionality: Captures areas where the volunteer can contribute. Validation: Values (e.g., Event Support , Tutoring , Graphic Design , Data Entry). Used to filter volunteers for specific opportunities.
Availability	Multi-select Picklist (or Matrix)	Functionality: Indicates preferred times to volunteer. Validation: Values: Weekday Mornings , Weekday Afternoons , Weekday Evenings , Weekends .
Emergency Contact Name	Text	Functionality: Name of the person to contact in an emergency. Validation: Required if Contact Type includes Volunteer .
Emergency Contact Phone	Phone	Functionality: Phone number for the emergency contact. Validation: Required if Emergency Contact Name is populated. Must follow valid phone formatting.
Background Check Status	Picklist	Functionality: Tracks the clearance level of the volunteer for sensitive roles. Validation: Values: Pending , Passed , Failed . Default is Pending .
Background Check Expiration Date	Date	Functionality: The date the current background check expires. Validation: Required if Status is Passed . Triggers an automated email alert to the volunteer and coordinator 30 days prior to expiration.
Total Hours Worked	Roll-up Summary	Functionality: Calculates the total lifetime volunteer hours. Validation: Read-only. Sums the 'Hours

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
		Completed' numeric field on all related 'Volunteer Shift' child records where Status = 'Completed'.
Preferred Volunteer Locations	Multi-select Picklist	Functionality: Preferred physical sites for volunteering. Validation: Values map to organizational facilities or regions (e.g., Downtown Center , Northside Clinic , Remote).

MODULE 3: BOARD OF DIRECTORS GOVERNANCE

This module manages board leadership roles, term limits, and fiduciary responsibilities.

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
Board Role/Title	Picklist	Functionality: Designates the specific leadership position on the board. Validation: Values: President , Vice President , Treasurer , Secretary , Member-at-Large . Only one active President allowed at a time.
Committee Assignment	Multi-select Picklist	Functionality: Tracks sub-committee memberships. Validation: Values: Finance , Governance , Fundraising , Marketing , Executive .
Current Term Start Date	Date	Functionality: The date the current board term began. Validation: Required if Contact Type includes Board . Must be in the past or today.
Current Term End Date	Date	Functionality: The scheduled end date of the current term. Validation: Must be strictly greater than the Current Term Start Date. Triggers review workflow 90 days before expiration.
Term Number	Number	Functionality: Indicates which consecutive term the member is serving. Validation: Integer only. Minimum value: 1. Used to enforce organizational term limits (e.g., max 3 terms).
Personal Giving Target	Currency	Functionality: The financial “Give-or-Get” goal agreed upon for the fiscal year. Validation: Supports two decimal places. Required for all active Board Members.
Give-or-Get Progress	Formula (Currency)	Functionality: Tracks progress toward the Personal Giving Target. Validation: Read-only. Formula: [Roll-up of Won Donations linked to Contact for Current Fiscal Year] + [Roll-up of Soft Credits/Solicited Donations for Current Fiscal Year] . Can be used to calculate a percentage-to-goal formula field.

MODULE 4: MEMBERSHIP MANAGEMENT

This module handles the lifecycle of formal memberships, including tiers, statuses, and financial dues.

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
Member Tier	Picklist	Functionality: Defines the level of membership and associated benefits. Validation: Values: Student , Individual , Family , Corporate , VIP . Determines the expected Annual Dues Amount.
Membership Status	Formula (Text)	Functionality: Dynamically calculates current standing based on dates. Validation: Read-only. Logic: IF(Membership Expiration Date >= TODAY(), "Active", IF(Membership Expiration Date >= TODAY() - 30, "Grace Period", IF(ISBLANK(Membership Expiration Date), "Pending", "Lapsed")))).
Join Date	Date	Functionality: The original date the constituent became a member. Validation: Static field once populated. Never updates upon renewal.
Last Renewal Date	Date	Functionality: The date the most recent membership payment was processed. Validation: Automatically updated via workflow when a new membership payment opportunity is marked 'Closed Won'.
Membership Expiration Date	Date	Functionality: The date the current membership privileges expire. Validation: Automatically calculated via workflow (e.g., Last Renewal Date + 365 days or fixed calendar year end). Triggers automated renewal reminder emails at 60, 30, and 5 days prior.
Unique Member ID	Auto-Number	Functionality: A system-generated unique identifier for membership cards and portals. Validation: Read-only. Format: MEM-{000000} . Generated upon creation of the membership record.
Annual Dues Amount	Currency	Functionality: The required financial contribution for the selected tier. Validation: Can be auto-populated based on Member

Field Name	Data Type	Functionality & Validation Rules
		Tier selection, but allows manual override for discounts/prorations.
Payment History Link	Related List (or Lookup)	Functionality: Connects the constituent to their transactional history. Validation: A one-to-many relationship linking the Contact to 'Transaction' or 'Opportunity' records representing dues payments.